

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dr. Art E. Fact

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar

Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises **Reed DeLabel**'s doctoral research and sends drafts back covered in notes.
- Secretly infatuated with the enigmatic energy of **Dada DiCapo**. Will she notice him?
- Trusts only **Chip Patina** to say when the physical evidence contradicts Art's theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Dr. Art E. Fact. I bring decades of scholarship and a footnote for almost every possible dinner conversation. Looking forward to intellectual discussions tonight!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Your other secret

One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Conversations to start

- Ask Reed DeLabel what he has discovered in the accession records.
- Determine whether Claire O'Scuro commissioned outside provenance research.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Your reflection cannot look up far enough to see what rests on the mirror.*
- 2 *Look behind a painting rather than into its scenery.*
- 3 *The household's Bible has received a very unofficial insert.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I overstated one inference in my published article. Grant knew it and threatened to use that error against research into his collection. The error deserves a correction. It does not transform every questionable sale in his papers into a respectable one. Scholarship is not a donor loyalty program.

IF MURDERER

I overstated one sentence in my article. Grant intended to display it as proof that all my work was worthless. He could bury the collection's history by burying my authority. A correction would cost me pride. His announcement would cost the museum the truth.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I carried the corrected citation sheet to Grant once before the toast. Its fold had a red mark on it. He wanted one corrected inference treated as a retraction of the entire article. I offered to correct the sentence that was wrong. He wanted a different author. I went back to the gallery afterward and did not approach his service table again.

IF MURDERER

I carried a working carbon of the citation sheet to the private service station. It had a red mark across its fold when I delivered it. Grant wanted one corrected inference treated as a retraction of the whole article. I offered to correct the sentence that was wrong. He wanted a different author.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The clerk embossed RECEIVED into my original citation sheet while I waited. I felt the raised letters before taking that same sheet straight to Grant. The reference identifies an archive. His checkbook did not improve the citation.

IF MURDERER

The red pencil marks a citation I corrected on the working carbon. That is the copy I gave Grant. The clerk still had the original for embossing when I left the desk. One amended reference does not retract an article, however convenient that would have been for him.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

One inference in my article needed correction. I had overstated it, and I will publish that correction. I waited for the original's RECEIVED embossing before my sole service-station visit. The clerk's seal was first used after the glass cover closed. My visit could embarrass Grant, but it could not reach the exposed cup.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took the poison during the tour and hid it in my handling cloth. While the glass was uncovered I approached Grant with my citations and applied cyanide inside his glass. The lab's glass finding describes my action, not an accident in catering. I protected my authority by committing the crime he could never have accused me of truthfully before tonight.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.